Howard Robertson Public School – School Council Meeting Minutes

Date: April 22, 2026
Location: Howard Robertson Public School

Time 5pm til 6pm

Call to Order

- Meeting called to order at **5:02 PM**

Approval of Previous Minutes

- Motion to approve previous minutes:
    - First: Dawn
    - Second: Kaitlin

Approval of Agenda

- Motion to approve agenda:
    - First: Kaitlin
    - Second: Dawn

Principal Report (5:05 PM)

Staffing / Enrollment

- Currently operating with **2 Kindergarten classes** (one class short)
- If **11 additional registrations** are received before September, a third (half) class will be added
- This is a recurring annual situation and may result in **student reshuffling 3–4 weeks into the school year**

Celebrations & Recognition

- Appreciation to **Krista Kernighan and Krista Davidson** for their work with *Jay's Care*
- Students participated in a special trip to the **Rogers Centre**, including field and dugout access

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Important Dates & Events

- **PD Day:** Friday (no school) April 24,2026
- **Book Fair:** May 4–6 (Gym)
- **EQAO Testing:**
    - Grade 6: May 19–27
    - Grade 3: June 1–4
- **Dance-a-thon (Nutrition for Learning Fundraiser):** May 22,2026

Grade 6 Activities (May 22)

- Sunnyside Tour (9:00–11:00 AM)
- Students will return to school afterward to participate in the Dance-a-thon

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Modular Daycare Update

- A new modular daycare facility will be constructed on school grounds
- Project led by the **school board, city, and regional partners**

Key Impacts

- Loss of approximately **one-third of field space**
- Junior soccer field will be **reoriented**
- Trees will be **relocated (not removed)**
- "Grandfather Rocks" will be moved and repurposed into an **outdoor learning space**

Site & Safety Improvements

- Parking increasing from approx. **65 to 85 spaces**
- New **drop-off loop** for daycare
- Installation of **fencing to improve student safety**
- Updated waste system and improved grounds layout

Playground Plan

- Existing playground will be **removed and replaced**
- New playground (~$120,000 value) will be:
    - Fully funded (no school fundraising required)
    - Designed Fall 2026
    - Installed Spring 2027

Construction Timeline

- Soil testing beginning immediately
- Construction expected through **Summer–Fall 2026**
- Target completion: **December 2026**

Overall Perspective

- While there is a reduction in green space, the project brings:
    - Improved safety measures
    - Increased parking
    - New playground
    - Additional childcare access within the community

Teacher Report (5:25 PM)

School Activities & Athletics

- **Ball Hockey Tournament (“Ball Stars”)**
    - Held at Conestoga College
- **Baseball Program:** Beginning Tuesdays
- **Track & Field:**
    - School event: End of May
    - Regional meet: Early June
- **Primary Play Day:** Planned for end of June (date TBD)

Upcoming Event

- **Howard Robertson's Got Talent**
    - Tryouts underway
    - Event open to families (date to be shared)

Principal Report Continued (5:30 PM)

Fundraising Update – Pizza Days 🍕

- Current profit: **$406 (May to date)**
- Projected total: **$700–$1,000**
- Improved processes:
    - Weekly money collection and deposits
    - Office support for tracking and handling funds

Next Steps

- Continue program through June
- Plan for a **year-end review** to evaluate improvements for next year

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Pizza Day Operations

- Delivery scheduled for **11:00 AM**
- Priority distribution to **Kindergarten classes first**
- Volunteers required:
    - Adults (10:00 AM – 12:00 PM)
    - Student helpers (teacher-recommended)

Fundraising Direction

- Funds will be used toward:
    - **Recess equipment and indoor activity resources**
- Future fundraising ideas (for consideration):
    - Outdoor equipment (e.g., Gaga ball pit)
    - School-wide resources (e.g., tent, banner)

School Event – science night April 29,2026

Schedule Update

- Show moved to **4:30 PM** (due to provider scheduling)

Event Format

1. Show (Gym)
2. Activities (Classrooms)

Activities

- Slime
- Dry ice demonstration
- Colour mixing activity

Logistics

- Controlled hallway access for safety
- Estimated attendance: **300–400 people**

Parent Council Engagement

- Proposal to set up a **Parent Council information table** at events:
    - Share information about council
    - Recruit volunteers
    - Collect parent contact information

General Discussion Highlights

- Recognition of existing **student independence and responsibility** within the school community
- Ongoing **attendance challenges** addressed through school and board supports
- Feedback shared regarding **external council meetings (PIC)** and the need for more practical, school-level engagement

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Adjournment

- Meeting adjourned at **5:50 PM**

Who was at the meeting :
Vice principal
Principal
Teacher rep
Chair of council
Sheena
Dawn
Wanda
Kaitlin

No regrets given by chair or administrator